

Armored Cars and Troop Carriers (cont.)

Armored half-tracks were used by Allied and Axis nations to carry infantry across country and under fire. Being versatile, they were used for different roles, including as platforms for antitank or anti-aircraft guns, towing vehicles for artillery, ambulances, maintenance workshops, and command vehicles. Fully tracked support vehicles were less common, but the popular Universal Carrier saw extensive use. Toward the end of the war, the Ram Kangaroo pioneered the concept of the fully tracked armored personnel carrier.

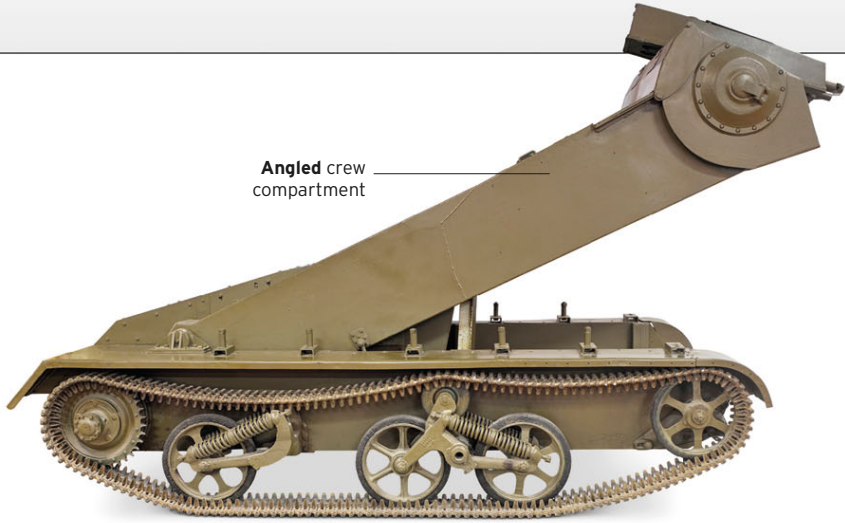


Machine gun tripod stowed on hull

▽ M5 half-track

Date	1943	Country	USA
Weight	10.9 tons (9.9 tonnes)		
Engine	IHC RED-450-B gasoline, 141 hp		
Main armament	.50 Browning M2 machine gun		

The Allies used the M2 and M9 as artillery tractors, and the M3 and M5 as armored personnel carriers. Both were put to a wide range of other uses during the war, including recovery, command, and ambulance. Israel used these vehicles for decades after 1945.



Angled crew compartment

△ Praying Mantis

Date	1943	Country	UK
Weight	5.8 tons (5.3 tonnes)		
Engine	Ford flathead V8 gasoline, 85 hp		
Main armament	2 x .303 Bren machine guns		

The Praying Mantis was a failed attempt to produce a very low-profile weapon carrier. The two-man crew lay prone inside the body, which could be elevated by hydraulics to see and fire over cover. Although innovative, it was difficult to operate and made the crew sick.

◁ M8 Greyhound

Date	1943	Country	USA
Weight	8.2 tons (7.4 tonnes)		
Engine	Hercules JXD gasoline, 110 hp		
Main armament	37 mm M6 L/56.6 gun		

The M8 was originally designed as a wheeled tank destroyer, but it soon became a reconnaissance vehicle because of its light armament. Its six-wheel drive gave it a high speed on roads, but its suspension limited it across country. The M8 was open-topped and thinly armored.



.50 Browning machine gun

Continuous track at rear